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BayGeo 2026

Open Map

2026.01 – Mapping BayGeo Membership

Submissions open July 10 – August 14, 2026

Overview

The BayGeo Open Map Challenge is a recurring open call celebrating the full range of mapping skills – from data management and cartographic craft to creativity and visual clarity. Each edition features a new dataset and theme, inviting the GIS and mapping community to apply their skills to real-world problems and earn recognition for their skills.

Selected maps will be featured on the BayGeo website with full cartographer credit, putting your work in front of the broader GIS and mapping community. Along with a shareable portfolio piece, selected mappers will also receive BayGeo membership and swag to call their own.

This inaugural edition challenges participants to work with the BayGeo membership registry – a real-world dataset requiring cleaning, interpretation, and thoughtful decision-making to produce a map that tells a story about who (and where) our BayGeo community is.

Who Can Enter

- Open to anyone – BayGeo membership not required
- **One submission** per participant
- Judges are not eligible to enter

Submission Tracks

- **Emerging Mapper Track**
 - Current students or recent graduates
 - Fewer than 2 years of professional GIS experience (internships, research assistantships, job experience, etc. where GIS was an essential component)
- **Open Track** – all experience levels
- Notes:
 - Participants must select one track at submission
 - Emerging Mappers are encouraged to challenge themselves in the Open Track
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The Dataset

- A subsample of BayGeo membership data, provided at zip code level
- Select attributes included: Account type and Enrollment year (some records incomplete)
- **All records have been anonymized; location information is limited to zip code granularity**

- Notes
 - Data requires cleaning and interpretation — this is intentional and reflects real-world GIS work
 - Decisions such as how to handle non-CA members are left to the participant and must be documented
 - **This dataset is provided for use solely in connection with the BayGeo Open Map Challenge 2026.01 and may not be redistributed or used for any other purpose**

Format

- Any GIS software or platform permitted (note AI guidelines below)
 - Do not use basemap-only tools (Google Maps, Bing Maps) as your primary cartographic platform – copyright restrictions appl

Access The Dataset

Submit Your Map



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